



COMPETING WITH A UNIQUE OFFERING

What is not readily available?

Can we create a product or service that is hard to find and that competitors cannot easily copy? For example:

- › **Create unique products** that cannot be found elsewhere, such as custom goods.
- › **Build a website** devoted to entirely local needs based on local knowledge.
- › **Find a niche** that is too small for bigger companies to be interested in.
- › **Select additional services** that will appeal to our customers.

COMPETING ON CUSTOMER SERVICE

What do customers really want?

Can we give customers a level of service better than our rivals so they stay loyal? For example:

- › **Provide a personal service** and know our customers by name.
- › **Make buying an enjoyable** experience for our customers so they come again.
- › **Develop a follow-up** service to encourage repeat purchases once a first purchase has been made.
- › **Offer flexible terms**, such as allowing customers to pay by installments or offering an extended returns policy.

Only **7%** of employees today fully understand their company's business strategy and what's expected of them

Robert S. Kaplan, American accounting academic

